

Topic 5.4

5.4: Conversion Summary

When converting a basic type to another basic type, use the built-in conversion functions.

When converting a basic type to a class type, write a constructor in the class that takes a single formal parameter of the type being converted from.

When converting a class type to a basic type, overload the appropriate conversion operator within the class.

When converting from a class type to another class type

- define a constructor in the class of the destination object, OR
- define a conversion function in the class of the source object.

The availability of the source code may influence this decision. If the C++ code for the *destination* class is unavailable, you *must* define a conversion function in the class of the source object. If the C++ code for the *source* class is unavailable, you *must* define a constructor in the class of the destination object. This may be impossible if the source class does not provide sufficiently good accessor functions to allow the destination class to obtain all required information from the source object.

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